

10.1.3 Restricting Access Over A Network

Whether we're talking about a home or an office network, you might have information on your network that you don't want to share, like files containing personal data or financial spreadsheets. Windows XP Professional gives you the ability to grant access to selected users while keeping others from accessing confidential files. Note that XP Home does not provide this feature.

The access control feature in XP Professional allows you to set a file or folder's access permissions for a specific user, computer, or group of users. You can set permissions, and define the type, level of access granted to a user or group for a particular file or folder. For example, you can grant Read and Write permissions to the entire user group for a file called spreadsheet.xls. You can let one user read the contents of a file, let another user make changes to the file, and prevent all other users



The Security tab for a file

changes to the file, and prevent all other users from accessing the file.

First, to change permissions on a file or folder, you must be the owner of that file (if you created the file or folder, then you are the owner of it) or folder, or you must have the permission (permission should be granted by the owner of that file) to make such changes. You can also set similar permissions on printers so that selected users can configure the printer and other users can only print using it.

To set, view, change or remove file and folder permissions, open Windows Explorer. Locate the file or folder you want to set permissions for. Now, right-click on the file or folder and click 'Properties'. Click the 'Security' tab (if you don't see the Security tab, then you are not part of a domain).

Next, choose the group or user name. If you need to add a group or user, click 'Add'. Type in the name of the group or user